NATIONAL SENIOR CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION
NOVEMBER 2025

ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE: PAPER II

Time: 3 hours 100 marks

PLEASE READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY

1. This question paper consists of 7 pages. Please check that your question paper is complete.

2. Utilise your reading time carefully, ensuring that the selections made showcase your ability to share your response to the texts.

3. Questions must be answered in **BOTH SECTIONS**. In **SECTION A**, Question 1 is **compulsory**, and then answer **ONE** question on the selected novel. In **SECTION B**, Question 6 is **compulsory**, and then answer **either** Question 7 **or** Question 8.

4. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.

5. **Begin each QUESTION on a new page.** Do not copy down headings for your answers. Copy down **only** the question numbers, making sure they are accurate.

6. You may answer the questions in whatever order you wish, but number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.

7. **No word count is required for ANY QUESTION.**

8. You are encouraged to give your own judgements. Attempt to create space in which your **own voice** will be evident. The examiners will judge your answers on your understanding of, and insight into the given texts. They will also assess the competence with which your answers are expressed.

9. Follow instructions in each question with meticulous care.

10. Answers must be written only in the Answer Book supplied.

11. It is in your own interest to write legibly and to present your work neatly.

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SECTION A LITERATURE

QUESTION 1

SHAKESPEARE: *OTHELLO*

THIS QUESTION IS COMPULSORY

Study the quotation below and then write a literary essay in response to the topic that follows.

'To get to objective reality, we have to reflect on perspective. Reality cannot, in principle, be seen as it is. Reality, as it is, is twisted.'

– Karsten Harries

[Adapted from: Harries, Karsten. *Infinity and Perspective*, Cambridge, Mass: MIT Press, 2001, p. 34. [<https://mitpress.mit.edu/9780262582186/infinity-and-perspective/>]]

TOPIC:

Critically discuss to what extent characters in Shakespeare's *Othello* **view reality** as **untrustworthy** and **twisted by perspective**.

You must refer to a minimum of **TWO** characters in your response.

Please note:

- Your response must be in the form of a well-structured literary essay.
- The length of your response must be **approximately 600 words**.
- Your knowledge of Shakespeare's text, *Othello,* and your ability to structure and substantiate your stance in order to develop a **tightly constructed argument** will be assessed.
- **Close** and **relevant** reference to the play is **essential**.
- Do **NOT** provide a word count at the end of your essay.

[30]

AND

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NOVELS

BRAVE NEW WORLD OR *THE WHITE TIGER*

Answer **ONE** question on your selected novel.

Answer **EITHER**

Question 2 (*Brave New World*)

OR

Question 3 (*Brave New World*)

OR

Question 4 (*The White Tiger*)

OR

Question 5 (*The White Tiger*)

Please note:

- Your response must be in the form of a well-structured literary essay.
- Your essay should be **approximately 600 words** in length.
- Your ability to select detail from the novel, in order to develop a **succinct argument**, which is clearly focused and perceptive, **will be assessed**.
- **Close** and **relevant** reference to the text in the question is **essential**.
- Do **NOT** provide a word count at the end of your essay.

EITHER

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QUESTION 2

BRAVE NEW WORLD: ALDOUS HUXLEY

Read the following:

'While the writer found many aspects of his world ridiculous or horrific, he used writing as a way to work through ideas about how an improved society might function.'

– Susanna Shapland

[Adapted from: <https://communitylivingmagazine.com/brave-new-world-satire-or-blueprint/>]

TOPIC:

Critically discuss whether Huxley, in *Brave New World*, interrogates **horrific** and **ridiculous aspects of humanity** as a way of imagining an **improved society**.

You must refer to a minimum of **TWO** characters in your response.

[30]

OR

QUESTION 3

BRAVE NEW WORLD: ALDOUS HUXLEY

Read the following:

'The world is suffering from intolerance, […] whereas what is needed in our very complex modern society is calm consideration, with readiness to call propaganda in question and freedom of mind to do justice to the most diverse points of view.'

– Bertrand Russell

[Adapted from: Russell, Bertrand. 'In Praise of Idleness: And Other Essays.' Routledge: 1984]

TOPIC:

Argue to what extent characters in Huxley's *Brave New World* possess the **freedom of mind** to **challenge propaganda** and **promote different perspectives**.

You must refer to a minimum of **TWO** characters in your response.

[30]

OR

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QUESTION 4

***THE WHITE TIGER:* ARAVIND ADIGA**

Read the following:

'While the writer found many aspects of his world ridiculous or horrific, he used writing as a way to work through ideas about how an improved society might function.'

– Susanna Shapland

[Adapted from: <https://communitylivingmagazine.com/brave-new-world-satire-or-blueprint/>]

TOPIC:

Critically discuss whether Adiga, in *The White Tiger*, interrogates **horrific** and **ridiculous aspects of humanity** as a way of imagining an **improved society**.

You must refer to a minimum of **TWO** characters in your response.

[30]

OR

QUESTION 5

***THE WHITE TIGER:* ARAVIND ADIGA**

Read the following:

'Literature about poverty has long been analysed for forms of prejudice – and resistance to this prejudice: the power of representation, the importance of authority, and the agency to act and speak for oneself.'

– Barbara Korte

[Adapted from: Barbara Korte. 'Can the Indigent Speak? Poverty Studies, the Postcolonial and Global Appeal of Q & A and The White Tiger.' Connotations Vol. 20.2-3: 293-312]

TOPIC:

Argue to what extent Adiga, in *The White Tiger*, portrays characters who **resist poverty** and **prejudice** in order to **act** for themselves.

You must refer to a minimum of **TWO** characters in your response.

[30]

60 marks

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SECTION B TRANSACTIONAL WRITING: SHORT PIECES

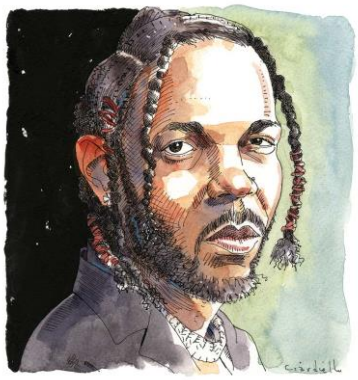
Please note:

- Answer **TWO** of the following questions.
- You must answer **Question 6 (compulsory)** and then answer **either Question 7 or Question 8**.
- The body of your response should be **approximately 250 to 300 words** in length.
- Remember to pay attention to the **register** and **purpose** of your text.
- It is essential that the **appropriate format** is used.

QUESTION 6

THIS QUESTION IS COMPULSORY.

Read the text below and then answer the question that follows.



On Monday, Kendrick Lamar's album, 'DAMN.' took home an even more elusive honour, one that may never have even seemed within reach: the Pulitzer Prize for music. Mr. Lamar is not only the first rapper to win the award since the Pulitzers expanded to music in 1943, but he is also the first winner who is not a classical or jazz musician.

'The time was right,' Dana Canedy, the administrator of the Pulitzer prizes, said in an interview after the winners were announced. 'We are very proud of this selection. It means that the jury and the board judging system worked as it's supposed to – the best work was awarded a Pulitzer Prize.'

She added: 'It shines a light on hip-hop in a completely different way. This is a big moment for hip-hop music and a big moment for the Pulitzers.'

– Joe Coscarelli

[Adapted from: <https://www.nytimes.com/2018/04/16/arts/music/kendrick-lamar-pulitzer-prize-damn.html>]

The Pulitzer Prize is regarded as one of the highest honours in print journalism, literary achievement, and musical composition. Write an **open letter** to the Pulitzer Prize committee where you either **celebrate** or **criticise** the judges' decision to **recognise hip-hop** as a **genre of artistic and lyrical depth**. You may refer to another form of **music or expression** that you believe should be recognised instead.

[20]

AND

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BOTH QUESTION 7 AND QUESTION 8 ARE BASED ON THE EXTRACT BELOW.

Read the text below and then answer **ONE** of the questions that follow.

In early 2015, when the 10,000-entry Oxford Children's Dictionary dropped around fifty words related to nature – words like *fern*, *willow*, and *starling* – in favour of terms like *broadband* and *cut* and *paste*, some of the world's most prominent authors composed an open letter of protest and alarm at this impoverishment of children's vocabulary and its consequent diminishment of children's belonging to and with the natural world.

Troubled by this loss of vital and vitalising language, Robert MacFarlane envisioned a 'wild dictionary' as a counterpoint to Oxford's deletion. Soon, *The Lost Words: A Spell Book* was born — an uncommonly wondrous and enchanting act of resistance to the severance of our relationship with the rest of nature, a rerooting into this living world in which, in the words of the great naturalist John Muir, 'when we try to pick out anything by itself, we find it hitched to everything else in the universe,' just as each word is hitched to all words and to the entire web of being.

– Maria Popova

[Adapted from: <https://www.themarginalian.org/2019/06/17/the-lost-words-macfarlane-morris/?mc_cid=e8fa87d5d3&mc_eid=675153c376>]

Answer **EITHER** Question 7 **OR** Question 8.

QUESTION 7

As a logophile[1], write an **email** to the editors of the Oxford Children's Dictionary arguing whether you believe **words related to nature** or **technology** best reflect **humanity's relationship with the world**. You must give **meaningful examples of language** as part of your response.

Glossary:

1. Logophile: a lover of words

[20]

OR

QUESTION 8

As a matriculant, you are on the threshold of leaving childhood behind. To reflect on your life thus far, you have decided to write a **eulogy for your childhood** – considering the important **milestones** that have **contributed to you becoming the person that you are**. You may refer to childhood as if it were a real person.

[20]

40 marks

Total: 100 marks

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